

Question 48 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Discuss the importance of evaluating training effectiveness for employees and organisations.

Introduction

Evaluation asks whether the training did what it was supposed to do. The notes say effectiveness must be valued against outcomes related to objectives, including learning, behaviour and impact on corporate objectives, not only trainee feelings. Importance is slightly different for employees (their learning and career) and for organisations (accountability and improvement), but both need the truth rather than certificates.

Detailed points

- 1. For employees — knowledge of their own progress.** Tests, demonstrations and coaching after training show what was mastered and what still needs practice. This is feedback, which is an HRD right. Without evaluation, the employee only has a certificate, not self-knowledge.
- 2. For employees — career and employability evidence.** Documented new competence supports internal growth talks and, more widely, employability — an HRD objective in the notes. Evaluation makes development visible, not only felt.
- 3. For employees — voice to improve future learning.** Reaction data and suggestions, if used honestly, make the next programme better. Employees are stakeholders, not passengers. Being asked ‘did this help your work?’ also signals a supportive climate.
- 4. For organisations — accountability for money and time.** Training uses budget and lost production hours. Managers who fund HRD must know whether it was worth it. Importance here is stewardship, not cruelty.
- 5. For organisations — improvement of the HRD process.** Evaluation locates the break: wrong need, weak design, poor delivery, or no transfer climate. Without it, the same weak course is repeated for years. The four-stage cycle cannot learn.
- 6. For organisations — strategy and results.** Level 4 type questions — did errors, quality, safety or customer measures move? — show whether capability for strategy increased. This is why HRD wants strategic status. Un-evaluated training cannot prove that status.
- 7. Avoiding two illusions.** False security: happy participants who do not perform. False failure: a strict trainer with low smile scores but high learning. Multi-level evaluation protects both employees and the organisation from these illusions.
- 8. Credibility of the HRD function.** Systematic evaluation moves HRD from the image of a department that arranges picnics to a professional function. That credibility brings future resources, which again helps employees’ development. Importance is therefore political as well as technical.

Conclusion. *For employees, evaluation gives feedback, career evidence and a voice. For organisations, it gives accountability, process improvement, strategic proof and protection from illusions. Evaluating training effectiveness is a duty of HRD, not an optional extra after the group photograph.*